

Hymns & Spirituals





About the Course

Students sing hymns and spirituals to build their faith and appreciation of God's work across time. Hymns and spirituals are connected to the historical time period as appropriate.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Music: Intro, Music: Level 1, Music: Level 2, Music: Level 3, Music: Level 4, Music: Level 5

Hymns & Spirituals

The Christian hymn and spiritual tradition is incredibly rich, and it is vanishing from many churches. In addition to bringing a much-needed moment of peace to your day, hymns can also introduce students to important theological ideas and church liturgy.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
1-12	Hymns & Spirituals 1 time/week 10 min	Our Hymns, Our Heritage

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Music: Intro				
Sol-fa: Musical Games	Hymns & Spirituals Afternoon Listening		Folk Songs	Music Appreciation
Music: Level 1				
Sol-fa: Level 1	Hymns & Spirituals Afternoon Listening		Folk Songs	Composer Study
Music: Level 2				
Sol-fa: Level 2	Hymns & Spirituals	Folk Songs	Composer Study Afternoon Listening	
Music: Level 3				
Sol-fa: Level 3 Afternoon Listening		Hymns & Spirituals	Folk Songs	Composer Study
Music: Level 4				
Sol-fa: Level 4 Afternoon Listening		Hymns & Spirituals	Folk Songs	Composer Study
Music: Level 5				
Sol-fa: Level 5 Afternoon Listening	Hymns & Spirituals	Folk Songs	Composer Study	



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Hymns & Spirituals

□ Bookmark the Alveary hymns, spirituals, and folk song playlist for the year, or create your own YouTube, Spotify, or Amazon playlist if desired.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Hymns & Spirituals



Our Work: Grades 1-2



Our Work: Grade 3



Our Work: Grades 4-6



Our Work: Grades 7-8



Our Work: Grades 9-12



Hymns, Spirituals, & Folk Songs PDF



Our Hymns, Our Heritage



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Hymns & Spirituals

How To Teach



Recap

- Specific recap questions are often suggested in the day's plans; ask students what they remember from the last lesson. If nothing comes to mind at first, tell them to give themselves another minute or two and to keep thinking. Our brains are amazing and can usually recall the previous lesson with a minute of effort. Refrain from doing the work of remembering yourself if you are leading the lessons.
- For composer study, a recap might look like a brief discussion about the name or sound of the piece you listened to previously.
- For hymns and folk songs, this might be an effort to hum the melody or recite the words of the song you're currently learning.
- For sol-fa, it might be a quick explanation of the sol-fa syllable you learned or a tricky rhythm or interval you were working to master.
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them a picture or sharing something that the teacher remembers. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, then teachers may consider continuing anyway or repeating the last lesson.



Introduce

- Prepare to listen to the day's musical selection by inviting students to consider an interesting musical or historical idea in the lesson. Perhaps it's a unique word, rhythm, instrument, or piece of historical background. You might introduce it by the way, or read a selection of a composer's bio or a brief article to students.



Listen & Sing

- Listen to the day's musical selection.
- Composer study lessons will usually have you listen to a piece of music for 3-8 minutes. If students have a difficult time listening for the duration of the lesson, stop the music at their limit.
- Some students might draw, color, or engage in a handicraft while listening to help extend their listening time. Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from: a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.
- Hymn, folk song, or sol-fa lessons will sometimes have you listen to a part of the song and then practice echoing back the melody and/or words.



Discuss

- Composer Study: Talk about the musical selection you heard. What stood out to you? What did you notice? What did it make you wonder? Did it remind you of anything? Discuss the tempo, the sound of the music, the instruments used, the volume, and the mood. Why do

you think the composer wrote it the way he did?

- Hymns, Spirituals, & Folk Songs: What lines strike you particularly? Is there a rhyme scheme to the lyrics? Is there a progression to each stanza? If you were to add a verse to the song, what would you add? If you took a verse out, how do you think it would change the song? Do the melody and words go together? Why or why not?

- Sol-fa: Take a minute to reflect on what you learned in the lesson. Write down any notes you want to remember and practice any particular exercises that were tricky.



Connect

- At the end of the lesson, think about how the day's musical selection connects to other books, subjects, characters in history, etc.
- You might copy down a stanza of a hymn in your Commonplace or Copywork book, read a bit more about the history behind a piece of music, jot down a noteworthy date in your Book of Centuries, or discuss a broader question raised in the lesson.

Hymns & Spirituals

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Term 1

WEEK 1

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 1

How Firm a Foundation

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage

PREP: Bookmark #57 in Our Hymns, Our Heritage.

→ INTRO

Our first hymn this year is called "How Firm a Foundation"

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Today, focus on getting familiar with the hymn. Read the words aloud and listen to the full song. Note that the recording includes a 4th verse which we are not learning this term (feel free to learn it as well if you're interested!). There are also a few other renditions of this hymn in the playlist if you prefer a different musical style. Just note the fact that the words might be slightly different than the ones in your hymnal/booklet.

∞ Audio Link: [How Firm a Foundation YouTube](#)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Learn the history of the song from your hymnal.
"Text and Tune" p.136

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Listen to Sibelius' tune which was used as the base for our hymn.

∞ **Video Link:** [Finlandia](#)

• AFTERNOON LISTENING

Use your preferred recording to listen to the hymn in the afternoons, evenings, or anytime! The more you spend time with it, the more the words will sink into your head and your heart.

• IMPORTANT DATE

Be Still My Soul composed by Katharina A. von Schlegel (Germany, 1700s)

WEEK 2

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 2

How Firm a Foundation (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Music PDF or Our Work Book
Materials: World Atlas or Globe

→ RECAP

What is the name of the hymn for this term and what is it about? What do you remember about how the song came to be written?

→ MAPWORK

Use your world atlas or globe and locate Germany, Finland, Scotland, and Wales

→ READ & SING

First read the lyrics aloud in your hymnal or Music PDF. Then practice the tune by first listening to a verse, then humming the next two.

∞ Video Link: [How Firm a Foundation Full Song](#)

WEEK 3

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 3

How Firm a Foundation (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Music PDF or Our Work Book

→ RECAP

Sing the tune of How Firm a Foundation on "hoo" and read the words aloud. Pay attention to the meaning and punctuation as you read.

→ SING

Today, listen to a line of the song, then pause the video and echo it back, working your way line by line through the song. This will help you focus on each line of the song, not just the ones which come easily to you.

∞ Video Link: [How Firm a Foundation Full Song](#)

• What images or lines in the song do you like best?

→ COPYWORK (GRADE 4+)

Copy a line of the melody into your music journal and (if you are taking sol-fa), see if you can label the notes with the sol-fa syllables. The song is in the key of Eb which means that the G the song begins on is "mi."

WEEK 4

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 4

How Firm a Foundation (cont.)

→ RECAP

Recite the hymn (as much as able)

→ SING

Try to sing the whole song with the accompaniment. Note the areas where you aren't as sure of the tune or the words.

∞ Video Link: [How Firm a Foundation Tune](#)

→ READ & DISCUSS

What story in the Bible does the end of the second verse remind you of? Read the story in Mark.

∞ Bible Link: [Mark 4:31-35](#)

Term 1

- Why do you think Katharina included this reference in the song? How does this story bring comfort?
- What other Bible verses or stories come to mind as you read this hymn?

WEEK 5

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 5

How Firm a Foundation (cont.)

→ RECAP

Sing hymn from memory (as able).

→ SING

Now that you know the words better, experiment with how you sing the song. Try singing it faster, slower, softly, loudly, or any other way you'd like to try. Think about how to emphasize the meaning of the words by the way you sing different verses. Are there other instruments you would use? Use the recording as needed.

∞ Audio Link: How Firm a Foundation Tune

→ READ & DISCUSS

In the original German, there were six verses to the song and then five when it was translated into English, though only three or four of those verses are commonly sung today. Read the original five verses. What do you think of the missing two verses? (Start learning them if interested!)

∞ Article Link: Original Lyrics, "Text: Translation"

WEEK 6

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 6

Children of the Heavenly Father Sing

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage

→ RECAP

Warm up your voice by singing "How Firm a Foundation."

→ INTRO

Time to start a new song! Have you heard of Charles Wesley before? He wrote a lot of different hymns including our new one: Children of the Heavenly Father Sing. What is this song about (if you've heard it before), or what do you think it will be about based on the title?

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Bookmark #74 in Our Hymns, Our Heritage and read the English words aloud. Then listen to the full song (note that there are a few small changes in the video lyrics ("a" Virgin versus "the" Virgin, etc.)).

∞ Video Link: Children of the Heavenly Father Sing Full Song

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Learn the history of the song from your hymnal.

"Text and Tune" p.170

- What did you think of George Whitefield's edits to the first first? Try singing Charles Wesley's first line instead and see what you think!

• EXTRA HELPINGS

For more on Charles Wesley and his hymns, see hymns #2, 31, 37, 41, 63, 86, and 103.

WEEK 7

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 7

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 7

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

Children of the Heavenly Father Sing (cont.)

→ RECAP

What is Children of the Heavenly Father Sing about?

→ READ, SING, & DISCUSS

First read the lyrics aloud. Write down the beginning of each verse to help you remember the order. Then work on the tune by listening to the first verse and then humming along with the last two. Slow down and pause the tune after each line and hum the melody back if you run into any tricky spots.

∞ Video Link: Children of the Heavenly Father Full Song

- Look back at the lyrics. How many different descriptions or titles for Jesus do you see? For instance, the first line starts with "newborn King."

→ LISTEN

As your hymnal mentioned, Children of the Heavenly Father Sing is sung the world over. With any extra time, look up the hymn in another language you're familiar with or interested in. A version in British Sign Language is linked below to get you started.

∞ Video Link: Children of the Heavenly Father (BSL)

• IMPORTANT DATE

Hark! the Herald Angels is composed with Whitefield's tweaks (1754AD).

Hymns & Spirituals

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QR

Term 1

WEEK 8

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 8

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 8

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

Children of the Heavenly Father Sing (cont.)

→ RECAP

Can you recite or sing the first verse without looking at the lyrics?

→ SING

Practice singing Children of the Heavenly Father Sing today. Pause the video after each line and sing it back. This will help you learn the song in its entirety and focus on each line.

∞ Video Links: Children of the Heavenly Father Full Song

→ DISCUSS

As our hymnal mentions, many different biblical references are woven into this hymn. Look back at the list on p.26 of Our Hymns, Our Heritage and pick a few verses to look up. Do you see the parallels? Are there other stories or verses the song reminds you of?

WEEK 9

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 9

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 9

Children of the Heavenly Father Sing (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Recite "Children of the Heavenly Father Sing" (as able).

→ SING

Warm up your voice by humming a favorite song, then sing "Children of the Heavenly Father Sing" with the accompaniment (without the words if you can!). Don't worry if you make a mistake; just keep going and then go back afterward to check the words and sing the song again.

∞ Video Link: Children of the Heavenly Father Sing Tune

→ EXPLORE

As musicians have played and sung this Christmas carol over the years, many have put their own spin on it as they meditated on the carol. Several different versions are linked in the playlist and feel free to look up others.

∞ Playlist Link: Hark! the Herald Options

WEEK 10

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 10

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 10

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

Children of the Heavenly Father Sing (cont.)

→ RECAP

Can you still sing "How Firm a Foundation" from the first part of the term?

→ SING

Sing the song without the accompaniment. Then check yourself with the recording.

∞ Video Link: Children of the Heavenly Father Sing Tune

∞ Video Link: Children of the Heavenly Father Full Song

→ REFLECT

- (Grades 1-5) If you drew an illustration to go with the song, what would you draw?
- (Grades 6+) How would the song change if you sung the verses in a different order? Do you think there is a progression of thought? If you wrote a 4th verse, what would it be about?

WEEK 11

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 11

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 11

Term Recap

→ RECAP

Try and recite both hymns from the term.

→ SING

Sing both of the term's hymns as if you were a soloist (you may choose to sing with or without the accompaniment)

∞ Video Link: How Firm a Foundation Tune

∞ Video Link: Children of the Heavenly Father Sing Tune

WEEK 12

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 12

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ ANSWER QUESTION(S) RELATED TO COURSE.

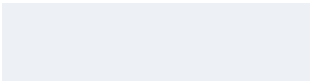
Hymns & Spirituals

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Term 1

Questions will come from:
Hymns & Spirituals



Term 2

WEEK 1

- 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 13
- 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 13

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

Angels We Have Heard On High

PREP: Bookmark #6 in your hymnal.

→ INTRO

Have you heard of William Cowper? He was friends with John Newton who wrote the famous song "Amazing Grace" that we're learning this term as well!

→ READ, DISCUSS, & LISTEN

Read through the words, discuss any words you don't know, and then listen to the full song. There are two tunes which are commonly used for this song. Our Hymns, Our Heritage features the tune "Dundee," but there is also a tune called "London" which the song is often sung to. As you get to know the song over the week, choose the one you prefer.

- ∞ Video Link: Angels We Have Heard (Dundee)
- ∞ Video Link: Angels We Have Heard (London)

→ READ & NARRATE

Learn the history of the song from your hymnal.
"Text and Tune" p.30

• IMPORTANT DATE

God Moves in a Mysterious Way composed (1774AD)

WEEK 2

- 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 14
- 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 14

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

Angels We Have Heard On High (cont.)

→ RECAP

What is "Angels We Have Heard On High" about?

→ SING

Today we're focusing on learning the tune and words separately. Listen to a verse and then hum along with the melody on the next one. If you need to focus on a particular part, pause the recording after each line and hum it back.

- ∞ Video Link: Angels We Have Heard (Dundee or London)

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read the words of the song aloud either in your hymnal, Our Work, or Music pdf. There are many word pictures in this hymn (God riding upon the storm, etc.). Which lines or images stand out to you? What do you think it means that "God is his own interpreter"?

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Explore the Olney hymnbook that Cowper and Newton published!
∞ **Book Link:** Olney Hymns

WEEK 3

- 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 15
- 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 15

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

Angels We Have Heard On High (cont.)

→ RECAP

Hum the tune of Angels We Have Heard On High.

→ SING

We're putting the tune and text together today, so listen to a line of the hymn, then pause and sing it back. If you feel confident in the words, you can sing along; echoing helps us pay attention to each line.

- ∞ Video Link: Angels We Have Heard (London or Dundee)

→ DISCUSS (GRADES 4+)

Read the full lyrics. How would the song feel different if the verses were in a different order? If you wrote another verse for the song, what would it be about and where in the song would you put it?

WEEK 4

- 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 16
- 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 16

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

Angels We Have Heard On High (cont.)

→ RECAP

Recite "Angels We Have Heard On High" from memory (as able).

→ SING

Sing the song with the accompaniment. The accompaniment only plays four verses, so sing along with the piano and then try singing the last two verse acapella (just your voice).

Term 2

- ∞ Video Link: Angels We Have Heard Tune
- Have you experienced times in your life where it felt like God's ways were "mysterious" and you didn't know what he was doing?

WEEK 5

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 17

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 17

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

Angels We Have Heard On High (cont.)

→ RECAP

Try singing Angels We Have Heard On High from memory.

→ SING

Review any places or spots you forgot while trying to sing from memory. Sing the song again with or without the accompaniment.

∞ Video Link: Angels We Have Heard On High Tune

→ EXPLORE

(Grade 6+) Optional: With extra time, compose another verse for the song (building on your discussion from a few lessons ago).

Listen to a few other renditions of our hymn. Which do you like best?

∞ Video Link: Version 2

∞ Video Link: Version 3

WEEK 6

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 18

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 18

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

O Worship the King

→ RECAP

Describe "Angels We Have Heard On High" as if telling a friend new to the song.

→ READ & LISTEN

We're starting a new song! Bookmark #118 in Our Hymns, Our Heritage. We don't know exactly when O Worship the King came into existence, but it is a spiritual, and as slavery grew in the American colonies during the 18th and 19th centuries, Christians who were enslaved started singing songs reminding themselves of God's power and the hope he brings beyond our sufferings.

∞ Video Link: O Worship the King (note that the recording says "toils" instead of "trials" on verse 2. Either is fine to sing.)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Learn the history of the song from your hymnal.

"Text & Tune" p.262

• AFTERNOON LISTENING

Be sure to listen to your songs for this term in the afternoon!

WEEK 7

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 19

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 19

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

O Worship the King (cont.)

→ RECAP

What do you remember about our new song?

→ SING

Read the words aloud and work on learning them. Then work on the tune by humming along with the singer. Spirituals often have more flexible tunes that each singer can customize, so don't worry about every note as much as getting the general flow of the song.

∞ Video Link: O Worship the King

→ DISCUSS

What is the mood or feeling of this song?

WEEK 8

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 20

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 20

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

O Worship the King (cont.)

→ RECAP

Can you hum the melody of O Worship the King?

→ SING

Sing along with the singer today.

∞ Video Link: O Worship the King

→ LISTEN

Term 2

Think about how you might make the tune your own as you listen to how a few other musicians have made it theirs! You'll notice that the words also vary slightly from our version, which another common feature of spirituals which were passed on orally rather than composed at a certain moment.

- ∞ Video: O Worship the King (Jackson)
- ∞ Video: O Worship the King (Cline)

WEEK 9

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 21

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 21

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

O Worship the King (cont.)

→ RECAP

Can you sing the refrain of "O Worship the King"?

→ SING

Sing along with the video and then try singing O Worship the King acapella (just your voice). Feel free to use lyrics or not and experiment with adding your own touches if you'd like.

- ∞ Video Link: O Worship the King

→ DISCUSS

What does it mean to walk close to God?

WEEK 10

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 22

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 22

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

O Worship the King (cont.)

→ RECAP

Sing "O Worship the King" from memory (as able).

→ SING

Look over any tricky places and sing through the song. Then try again without any lyrics (and see if you can see it from memory). Experiment with singing it faster or slower and think about how you might want to sing each verse and refrain differently to emphasize the meaning. (For instance, maybe you sing one refrain very softly and pleading and another like a desperate cry)

- ∞ Video Link: O Worship the King (optional reference)

WEEK 11

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 23

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 23

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

Term Recap

→ RECAP

Hum a tune you know well to warm up your voice.

→ SING

Sing both the term's hymns as if you were a soloist (you may choose to sing with or without the accompaniment for Angels We Have Heard)

- ∞ Audio Link: Angels We Have Heard On High Tune

WEEK 12

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 24

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Hymns & Spirituals

Term 3

WEEK 1

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 25

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 25

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

Hallelujah! What a Savior

→ INTRO

Do you remember Charles Wesley who wrote Children of the Heavenly Father Sing We're learning another of his hymns this year!

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Read the words aloud from your Our Work/Music PDF. Note that verse 5 is not included in our video recording, so mark that out or bracket it off to learn on your own time if interested! Charles Wesley wrote this at his conversion and the original song had 18 verses! Discuss any words that are new to you, then listen to the full song.

∞ Video Link: Hallelujah! What a Savior

→ READ & DISCUSS

Our Hymn, Our Heritage "Text & Tune" p.202

• IMPORTANT DATE

O for a Thousand Tongues composed (1739)

WEEK 2

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 26

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 26

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

Hallelujah! What a Savior (cont.)

→ RECAP

What is the name of our song this term, and what is it about?

→ SING

Hum a favorite tune to warm up your voice. Then alternate between listening to a verse and "hooing" (sing the tune on "hoo") along with the recording for a verse to learn the tune.

∞ Video Link: Hallelujah! What a Savior

→ PRACTICE

Continue learning the words. Read the whole song aloud. Write down the first line of each verse to help you remember the order, sketch a small illustration for each verse to help you visualize it, and do anything else you like to help yourself learn the words!

→ READ & DISCUSS (GRADE 5+)

Read the original 18 verses of Charles Wesley's hymn.

∞ Article Link: Original Lyrics

• Are there any stanzas that our version leaves out that you wish were included? Why do you think the ones we're learning have become the most popular?

WEEK 3

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 27

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 27

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

Hallelujah! What a Savior (cont.)

→ RECAP

Hum "Hallelujah! What a Savior."

→ SING

We'll put the words and tune together today! Listen to the song and pause it after each line to echo it back. Try to think about the meaning of the words as you sing.

∞ Video Link: Hallelujah! What a Savior

→ DISCUSS

Where do you see Charles Wesley meditating on Scripture in this hymn? For instance, it seems like Isaiah 35:5-8 and a number of other scriptures must have been in the back of his head when he wrote verse 4.

∞ Article Link: Verse 4 References

WEEK 4

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 28

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 28

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

Hallelujah! What a Savior (cont.)

→ RECAP

What is your favorite verse of "Hallelujah! What a Savior"?

→ SING

Hum a hymn from last term to warm up your voice. Then sing with the accompaniment (ignore the lyrics on the video as they are not in the same order as yours). Note any spots where you need to work more.

Term 3

∞ Video Link: Hallelujah! What a Savior Tune

→ DISCUSS & WRITE (GRADE 6+)

The verses for Hallelujah! What a Savior have been published in a variety of ways. Look back at the original verses; if you were a publisher and could select 4-6 verses, which would you choose and what order would you put them in? Do you see a flow of thought to the order you've learned? If you choose a different order, explain your thought process.

∞ Article Link: Original Lyrics

WEEK 5

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 29

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 29

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

Hallelujah! What a Savior (cont.)

→ RECAP

Recite "Hallelujah! What a Savior" (as able).

→ SING

Hum a favorite tune to warm up your voice. Sing with the accompaniment and then try to sing the hymn without any recording. Can you sing it all from memory?

∞ Video Link: Hallelujah! What a Savior Tune

→ LISTEN

As our hymnal mentioned, there is a second tune which is often put with Hallelujah! What a Savior. What do you think of it?

∞ Video Link: Hallelujah! What a Savior V2

WEEK 6

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 30

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 30

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

Hallelujah! What a Savior?

→ RECAP

Sing "Hallelujah! What a Savior."

→ INTRO

Our last hymn for the year is from the Appalachian region of the US and has some beautiful themes related to Easter and Jesus's death and resurrection.

→ SING & PRACTICE

Read the lyrics aloud and then listen to the full song (choose one of the two options).

∞ Video Link: Hallelujah! What a Savior V1

∞ Video Link: Hallelujah! What a Savior V2 (note that one line in verse 4 is slightly different, so adjust in your book if using)

→ READ & DISCUSS

Learn the history of the song from your hymnal.
"Text & Tune" p.178

WEEK 7

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 31

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 31

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF and US Atlas

Hallelujah! What a Savior? (cont.)

→ RECAP

Tell what you know about "Hallelujah! What a Savior?" Do you know where Appalachia is on the map? Locate it!

→ SING

Hum a favorite tune to warm up your voice. Then alternate between listening to a verse and "hooping" a verse to practice the tune.

∞ Video Link: Hallelujah! What a Savior V1

∞ Video Link: Hallelujah! What a Savior V2

→ DISCUSS

Did you notice how many phrases are repeated in the song? How do you think the song would be different if it didn't have so much repetition?

WEEK 8

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 32

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 32

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

Hallelujah! What a Savior? (cont.)

→ RECAP

Can you hum the tune of Hallelujah! What a Savior?

Term 3

→ SING

If you are feeling confident with the melody, sing the full song along with the recording. For any sections that you find difficult, pause your preferred recording after a line and echo it back.

- ∞ Video Link: Hallelujah! What a Savior V1
- ∞ Video Link: Hallelujah! What a Savior V2

→ EXPLORE

Listen to the ways a few different musicians have adapted and performed this song. What are the different instruments you notice? How do different performers make the tune their own?

- ∞ Video Link: Hallelujah! What a Savior V3
- ∞ Video Link: Hallelujah! What a Savior V4

WEEK 9

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 33

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 33

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

Hallelujah! What a Savior? (cont.)

→ RECAP

Can you sing the first verse of Hallelujah! What a Savior?

→ SING

Sing "Hallelujah! What a Savior?" on "hoo." Then sing the song with the accompaniment (be sure to use the words in your PDF or hymnal) and check your work. Go back and listen to the full song if needed.

- ∞ Video Link: Hallelujah! What a Savior Tune
- ∞ Video Link: Hallelujah! What a Savior V1 or V2

→ DISCUSS

Do you think there is a pattern to the verses? How would the song change if you rearranged them? If you wrote another verse, what would it be about and where would it fit?

WEEK 10

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 34

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 34

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

Hallelujah! What a Savior? (cont.)

→ RECAP

Orally or in writing, describe "Hallelujah! What a Savior?" as if talking to a friend who hasn't heard of it.

→ SING

Hum a favorite tune to warm up your voice. Sing with the accompaniment recording and then try to sing the hymn without any recording. Can you sing it all from memory?

- ∞ Video Link: Hallelujah! What a Savior? Tune

WEEK 11

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 35

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 35

Term Recap

→ RECAP

Hum a hymn from last term (or even last year!) to warm up your voice.

→ SING

Sing both of the term's hymns as if you were a soloist (you may choose to sing with or without the piano accompaniment)

- ∞ Audio Link: Hallelujah! What a Savior Tune
- ∞ Audio Link: Hallelujah! What a Savior Tune

WEEK 12

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 36

10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Hymns & Spirituals

Hymns & Spirituals

Examination

- Term 1** · Sing "Be Still My Soul" OR "Hark! The Herald Angels Sing."
- Term 2** · Sing "Just a Closer Walk with Thee."
- Term 3** · Sing "What Wondrous Love is This" or "O for a Thousand Tongues to Sing."